

integrate their own programs / tools / services with those of Google. For example, the Google AdWords API allows one to manage an AdWords account programmatically.

5. **Google Code Blog:** an interesting and informative place where visitors are updated on all the latest undertakings by Google, its engineers, organisations associated with Google, and the grants given by the company. Users can subscribe to the blog and be updated about all the developments. Besides, there is a discussion list for each product on Google Groups monitored by external developers and the concerned Google engineer.
6. **Featured Products:** a column that presents some promising tools that programmers have contributed for use by all. Each product description is accompanied by details such as the tools and APIs used.

1.3 Google APIs

The APIs provided by Google here are fairly extensive. These are powerful tools that provide programmers with many features to enhance their productivity and projects. Some of the prominent and useful APIs are as follows.

1. **The AdWords API** allows development of programs to interact directly with the AdWords server. This is particularly useful for advertisers to manage their AdWords accounts and campaigns more efficiently.
2. **The Google Desktop SDK** allows users to integrate Google Desktop into their own applications, and also to customise it to their needs.
3. **Google Earth KML:** Keyhole Markup Language (KML) allows for modelling and storing of geographic information for display in Google Earth. Browsers process KML files in the same manner as

HTML or XML with its many tags for specifying the display properties. This allows the programmer to do amazing things using Google Earth which is, in fact, a browser for KML files. Among the many features that it offers, one of the best is the ability to specify the camera angle. There is also the ability to dynamically update the KML files from remote or local servers. You can also bookmark (the Google folks call it “Placemarking”) your favourite spots on Google Earth and share them with friends.

1.4 Summer Of Code

The Google Summer of Code was an International competition that attracted participants and mentors from over 90 countries. As part of this the participants worked on a variety of open source software. This page provides write-ups prepared by various organisations (that mentored students) on their experience of the entire process.

1.5 Open Source Projects

The Projects page has a listing of all the projects that Google has provided for open source development. For programmers, these are slices of Google technology out of the labs. Apart from giving a brief about the project, there is also a discussion forum associated with each project, wherein the user can interact with other programmers. The only requirement for obtaining the source code, and for posting messages on the forum is a Google account.

Some of the projects available here are AdWords API Client Libraries, CoreDumper, GoogleTAGS, Sitemap Generator, and Testar.

The AdWords API Client libraries is for those users who wish to access Google AdWords accounts programmatically. It allows the coder to develop clients for the same purpose, and for this, it provides the entire Java Client library in a single file.